

7.7 SHOCK

Shock is a syndrome that results from a decrease in effective circulating blood volume in the body as a result of injury or illness. It can vary from faintness to complete collapse.

Shock can lead to;-

- Early loss of consciousness that mainly involves the nervous system and that may be fatal.
- Progressive loss of blood from active circulation, which may lead to falling heart output and insufficient oxygen to cells that are vital for survival.
- Sustained lowered blood pressure which may lead to liver and kidney failure.

STUDENT'S ACTIVITY

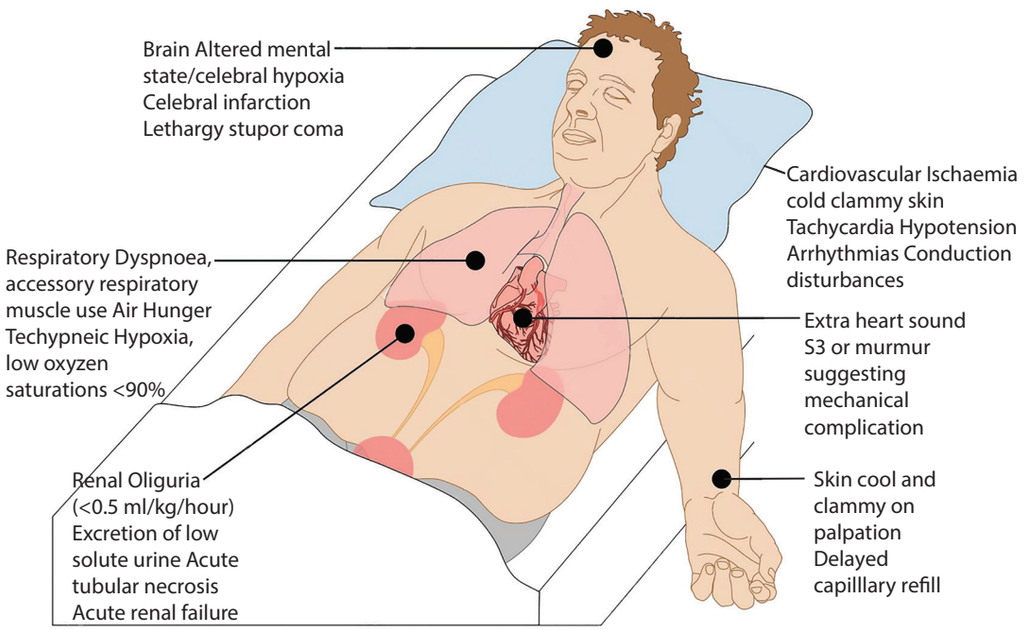
What you will do with the victim has shallow and rapid breathing, fainting with feeble pulse and fall of blood pressure.

Causes of shock; -

- Severe or extensive injuries
- Severe pain
- Loss of blood
- Severe burns
- Electric shock
- Exposure to extreme heat and cold
- Allergic reaction
- Bites or stings
- Gas poisoning
- Emotional illness.

Symptoms;-

- Casualty is anxious and restless
- Weakness and fainting
- Giddiness & disorientation
- Shallow, rapid or gasping breathing
- Skin become pale, cold and clammy



Nursing-voc_Unit 07.indd 206 2/23/2019 2:50:16 PM